Grade 3 · Reading Comprehension

Thanksgiving Reading Comprehension

4 passages · Comprehension questions · Vocabulary · Written response · Answer keys

The Harvest Feast of 1621 — Nonfiction

Sarah Hale Never Gave Up — Biography

Giant Balloons in the Sky — Nonfiction

Maya's Thankful Jar — Fiction

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Nonfiction

The Harvest Feast of 1621

1 In 1620, a ship called the Mayflower sailed from England to North America. The people on the ship were called the Pilgrims. They built a small town called Plymouth, in what is now Massachusetts.

2 The land was already home to the Wampanoag people. The Wampanoag had lived there for thousands of years. They knew how to fish, hunt, and grow food in that place.

3 The first winter was very hard for the Pilgrims. It was cold, and they did not have enough food. About half of them got sick and died.

4 In the spring, a man named Tisquantum helped the Pilgrims. He spoke English, and he showed them how to plant corn. He also taught them where to catch fish and eels.

5 By the fall of 1621, the Pilgrims had a good harvest. They had a celebration that lasted three days. The Wampanoag leader, Massasoit, came with about ninety of his men. The Wampanoag brought five deer to share.

6 People today often call this meal the first Thanksgiving. It did not look like a modern Thanksgiving dinner. There were no pies, because the Pilgrims had no ovens and very little sugar. They likely ate deer, wild birds, corn, and fish.

7 The Wampanoag people still live in Massachusetts today. They remember this history in their own way, too.

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The Harvest Feast of 1621

Read the passage again. Then answer the questions.

1. Who lived on the land before the Pilgrims came?

A) The English
B) The Wampanoag people
C) The sailors of the Mayflower
D) Nobody

2. How did Tisquantum help the Pilgrims?

A) He gave them a new ship
B) He built their houses
C) He showed them how to plant corn
D) He took them back to England

3. Why were there no pies at the 1621 feast?

A) Nobody liked pie
B) They had no ovens and little sugar
C) It was too hot to bake
D) The Wampanoag did not allow it

4. The word harvest means...

A) a big boat
B) gathering crops that are ready
C) a cold winter
D) a kind of bird

5. How was the 1621 feast different from a Thanksgiving dinner today? Use two details from the text.

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My Thankful Jar

Write or draw five things you are thankful for inside the jar.



Which one are you the MOST thankful for? Why?

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